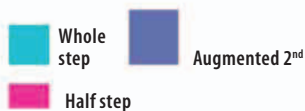


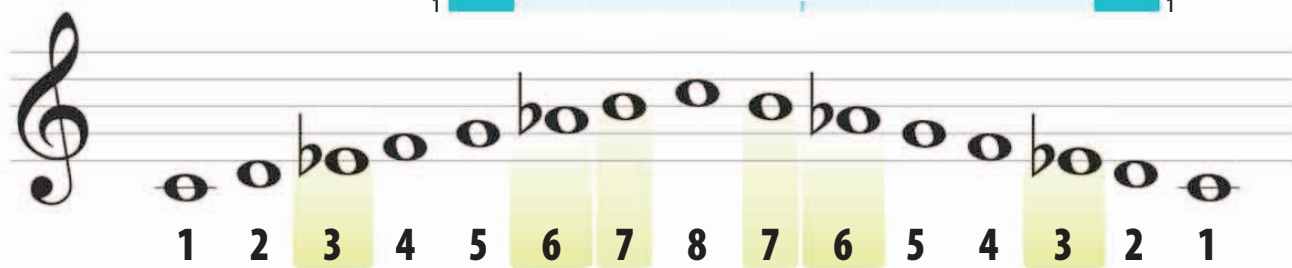
The harmonic minor scale

In the harmonic minor scale, the 3rd and 6th notes are lowered by a half step going up and down the scale. The 7th note is not lowered at all. Unlike other minor scales, the harmonic minor scale has an augmented 2nd—three half steps—between its 6th and 7th notes.



▽ C harmonic minor scale

In the harmonic minor scale starting on C, E becomes E $\flat$ and A becomes A $\flat$, but B is still B.



▽ Pattern of the scale

This pyramid shows the pattern followed by the harmonic minor scale, going up and down the scale.

The melodic minor scale

In melodic minor scales, the 3rd note is lowered by a half step going up and down the scale. The 6th and 7th notes are not lowered going up the scale, but they are lowered by a half step going down the scale.



▽ C melodic minor scale

E always becomes E $\flat$, but it is only on the way down the scale that B becomes B $\flat$ and A becomes A $\flat$.



▽ Pattern of the scale

Here is how the pattern of whole steps and half steps going up the melodic minor scale is different from the pattern going down the scale.